

AN API

OpenLeave

To provide for the uniform determination of employee leave entitlements under federal and state law; to cite the authority for every conclusion; and for other purposes.

SERIES SEED · JULY 2026

leave law, as code · github.com/geneweng/cc_rules_as_code

§ 1

THE PROBLEM

One remote employee in a state triggers that state's program.

US DOL, FMLA/PFML
interplay guidance, 2026

Leave law is fragmenting faster than anyone can *re-code it*.

13+DC

STATES WITH MANDATORY PAID-
LEAVE PROGRAMS

2/yr

NEW STATE PROGRAMS
LAUNCHING (MN & DE, JAN
2026)

1×/yr

EVERY STATE RE-SETS RATES,
CAPS & WAGE BASES

Every HR platform, payroll provider, and insurer employs analysts to read the same statutes and hand-code the same rules — into black boxes that disagree with each other and must all be re-coded every January.

The rules layer is the industry's largest *duplicated, non-differentiating* cost.

§ 2

THE PRODUCT

*Every conclusion carries the citation
that produced it — auditable line-
by-line against the statute.*

The rules layer, *sold as an API*.

Send a fact pattern; get the determination for every applicable law — with the legal authority attached.

```
POST /determinations
{ "employee": { "work_state": "MN", "hours_last_12mo": 1400, "aww": 1100 },
  "employer": { "total_employees": 85 }, "event": { "type": "bonding" } }

→ 200 OK

FMLA          eligible · 12 weeks · job-protected · unpaid          [29 U.S.C. § 2611]
MN Paid Leave eligible · 12 weeks · $896.76/week                    [Minn. Stat. § 268B.06]
interaction leaves run concurrently when designated                 [DOL guidance 2026]
```

Justification trees, not verdicts. Effective-date time travel — evaluate any determination under the law as of any date. Open-textured questions return `requires_human_judgment`, never a fabricated answer.

§ 3

WHY NOW

LLMs can draft policy-to-code translations reliably — with retrieval and human review.

Beeck Center, Policy2Code, 2025

AI changed *both sides* of the equation.

Encodings became cheap to maintain.

Maintaining 60+ jurisdiction encodings was the reason this business never existed. LLM-drafted amendment diffs — validated by regression tests, approved by attorneys — collapse that cost. What was a headcount problem is now a review workflow.

And a new customer appeared.

HR copilots are shipping everywhere, and they answer leave questions confidently and wrong. Every one of them needs a deterministic, citation-backed oracle behind the conversation. We are the API their answers should come from.

The window: incumbents treat their rules encoding as sunk cost; none can open-source it without unbundling themselves.

§ 4

THE MOAT

A diff that rewrites an in-force value breaks pinned historic determinations and is rejected automatically.

Amendments become *reviewed diffs*, not projects.

```
// NYSDOL notice, 2027 NYSAWW – drafted by the pipeline, cited to source
```

```
ny.saww 2026-01-01 $1,839.34
```

```
ny.saww + 2027-01-01 $1,925.14 “Effective January 1, 2027 …”
```

- i The LLM drafts.
Watches legislatures and agency feeds; separates machine-appliable parameter changes from rule-structure changes, which always route to a human encoder.
- ii The regression suite gates.
Every diff runs against pinned historic determinations. Hallucinated keys and rewritten history fail closed.
- iii An attorney signs.
Nothing ships without recorded human approval. Provenance — source hash, model, reviewer — travels with every change. Customers get the webhook: “this affects 14 of your open leaves.”

§ 5

MARKET

Regulatory complexity is the category's named growth driver.

Verified Market Research;
Mordor Intelligence, 2026

A billion-dollar category built *on top of* our layer.

\$1.4B

ABSENCE & LEAVE SOFTWARE,
2026

9.5%

CATEGORY CAGR THROUGH 2035

\$18B

BROADER ABSENCE-
MANAGEMENT SPEND

Every dollar of it depends on a correct encoding of leave law — today rebuilt privately by each vendor.

The wedge is leave; the market is employment law. The same engine, pipeline, and trust extend to wage & hour, pay transparency, and termination rules — the full multi-state compliance stack that platforms like Mosey and SixFifty describe in documents, delivered as determinations.

§ 6
COMPETITION

Incumbents advertise the encoding as internal capability — “200+ statutory policies,” each maintained privately, none sold.

Everyone builds the rules layer.
Nobody sells it.

WHO	WHAT THEY SELL	THE RULES LAYER
Cocoon · Sparrow · Tilt AbsenceSoft	Leave administration workflow	Hand-coded internally; opaque; a cost center
SixFifty · Mosey	Policy documents & obligation tracking	Text generation — no executable determinations
HRIS / payroll / EOR Rippling · Gusto · Deel	The systems of record	A checkbox they must offer and don't want to own
OpenLeave	The rules layer itself, as an API	Open-source encodings · AI-maintained · citation-backed

Open source is the trust strategy: a determination you can audit against the statute, versus a black box — and a moat incumbents can't copy without giving away what they consider their IP.

§ 7
BUSINESS MODEL

*The encodings are free. The currency
— maintenance, SLA, history, alerts
— is the subscription.*

Open-core: the code is free,
being current is the product.

BUYER	WHY THEY PAY	MODEL
Payroll / HRIS / EOR	Replace an internal rules team with an API line-item	Platform license
Leave platforms	Shed their largest non-differentiating cost	Per covered employee
Insurers & TPAs	Determinations at claims scale, with audit trails	Per determination
AI copilots	A citation-backed oracle behind the chat	Per call (MCP)

Compounding economics: each jurisdiction is encoded once and sold to every customer, while the AI pipeline holds marginal maintenance cost near zero — the inverse of every incumbent's cost structure.

§ 8

TRACTION

*Working code, public repo — every
claim in this deck is demonstrable in
the prototype today.*

The engine *runs today*.

Five regimes encoded, four jurisdictions — FMLA + California (CFRA/PFL), Minnesota Paid Leave, New York PFL — with per-clause citations and benefit formulas computed to the cent.

37-scenario regression suite pinning historic determinations — the contract an amendment can't silently break.

AI amendment pipeline, end to end — LLM-drafted diffs, automatic validation gate, human sign-off with full provenance.

Live API + eligibility checker — determinations with justification trees, effective-date time travel demonstrated across the 2026→2027 NY rate change.

Next: three paid design partners (payroll/EOR first) · 15 jurisdictions · SOC 2 · the kill/scale metric: $\geq 80\%$ of amendment diffs accepted with only minor human edits.

§ 9

THE ASK

*18 months to prove the two numbers
that decide the company: design-
partner revenue and pipeline
efficiency.*

Raising a *\$2.5M seed*.

50

STATE ENCODINGS FUNDED

3+

PAID DESIGN PARTNERS

18mo

RUNWAY TO SERIES A METRICS

Use of funds: two encoding engineers, one employment-law counsel (the human in the loop is a hire, not a vendor), pipeline infrastructure, SOC 2.

Team. Gene Weng, founder. Founding engineer and advisory counsel searches under way — this round funds both.

BE IT ENACTED,

Stop re-coding the law.
Start calling it.

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github.com/geneweng/cc_rules_as_code

Prototype figures are demonstrations; statutory parameters are approximations pending counsel review. Decision support, not legal advice.